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and interpret or create awareness about NetApp technology. We even enable access to shared learning resources like NetApp's Massive Open Online Courses (MOOCs) and Virtual Simulators (VSIMs). This gives participants the opportunity to get the NetApp Certified Software Associate (NCSA) certification, which increases their chances to get better jobs in the industry.

The Academic Alliances Programme also provides faculty and schools with teaching resources that they otherwise might not have access to – for example, the latest storage technology courses, self-paced labs, the latest analyst reports, and customer case studies.

Q Do you have a formal internship programme to train freshers for the industry? How is this designed?

NetApp has a dedicated internship programme that provides meaningful work to enhance industry knowledge as well as gain an insight into the company. The duration of this programme is 6-12 months and interns can be converted to full-time employees based on their performance. The internship programme is based on three Es – education, exposure and experience. The programme is built to provide meaningful work to enhance industry and NetApp knowledge. It also provides a diversity of interactions through cross-functional engagements with senior leadership.

In addition, we also conduct online hackathons and programming contests for budding coders to sharpen their skills. The winners of these contests stand a chance to win an internship with the company.

Q Can any student apply for your internship programme? How do you select your interns?

There are various criteria based on which we select interns. This includes

partner colleges, and eligibility in terms of degree, branch and graduation percentage. We hire interns after a few rounds of online tests and interviews.

Q How do you motivate your team at NetApp? Over the years, what have you learned about motivating young engineers?

NetApp is an employee-first company; it's our employees who bring the energy, passion, and mettle it takes to achieve our vision. Young engineers need a great place to work. We have currently 2000+ employees. Close to 70 per cent of our workforce comprises millennials and our campus is built to house the facilities that they need and get motivated by. Our leaders play a crucial role in employee motivation and lead by example. They are very approachable and take pride in mentoring young talent. We've been in India for about two decades and our employees work on path-breaking technologies. Innovation is vital to us, and the all-round health of our employees is important to prepare a fertile ground for disruptive ideas. We look at well-being holistically by providing flexible working hours.

The NetApp Employee Assistance Programme is an all-round wellness programme available 365 days a year. We also have an onsite doctor and an ergonomist. Our Bengaluru campus has varied opportunities for recreation and the comfort of all our employees. The 15-acre campus has ample free lung space that has been earmarked for an eco-pond, green spaces, a jogging track, and a sports ground. Over 70 per cent of the area is landscaped lawns, which is key to the aesthetic appeal of the building. Inside the building, the sports amenities include two indoor badminton courts, a fully equipped gymnasium, with facilities for yoga and aerobics. Foosball and table tennis vie for attention with the X-box, chess and carrom. **END** 🐧